# Chapter 8 The Hunter 16 System Utility

This chapter describes the UTIL utility, which provides access to a number of utility functions unique to **Hunter 16**. This chapter summarises how to use these functions, for ease of reference; they have also been described in context elsewhere.

## 8.1 Introduction

The functions provided by UTIL are not intended for everyday use. Indeed, you may never need to use them. For more detailed information on how and why you should use them, see:

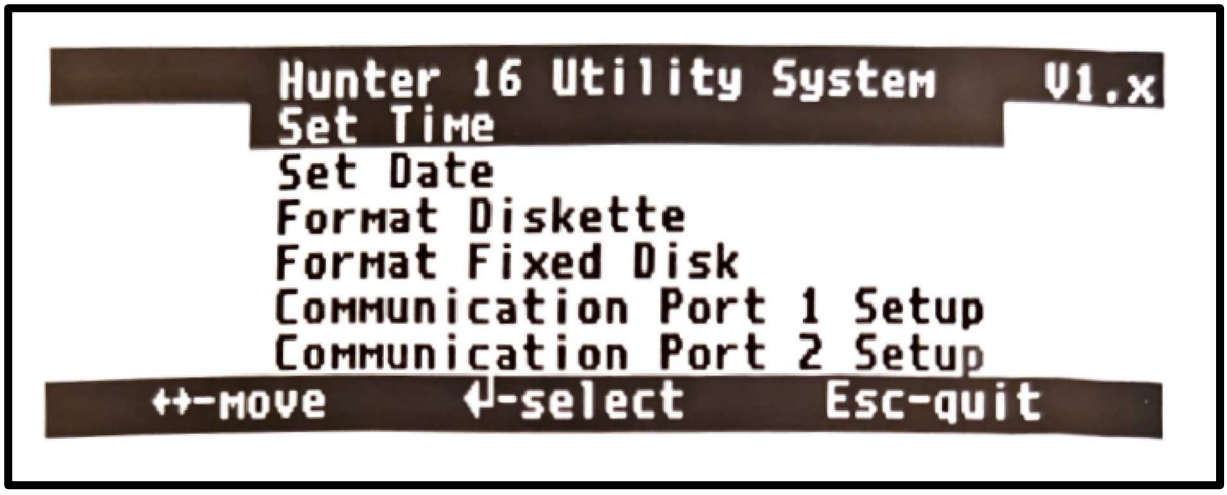
| Function | Chapter |
|---|---|
| Set time/date | Correcting the time (eg when crossing time zones): Chapter 5, Using Hunter 16<br>If the clock gets corrupted: Chapter 7, Troubleshooting |
| Format diskette | Formatting disks: Chapter 5, Using Hunter 16 |
| Format fixed disk | If memory or RAM disk gets corrupted: Chapter 7, Troubleshooting<br>Using extra memory: Chapter 13, Hunter 16 Accessories |
| Comms ports | Setting up communications ports: Chapter 11, Introduction to Communications |

## 8.2 Using the utility

To use UTIL, select MS-DOS command mode and type:

```
C:\UTIL [RETURN]
```

This displays the main UTIL menu, like this:



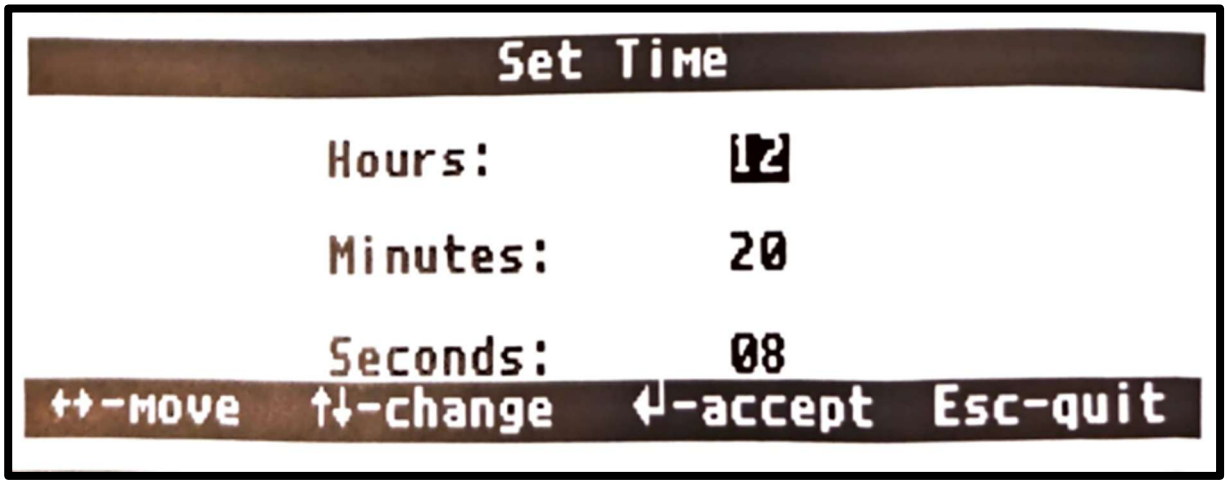

The keys that you can use are displayed at the base of the screen. For example, to select an option, move the highlight to it by using the [Left] or [Right] key, then press [RETURN].

To return to command mode, press [Esc].

## 8.3 Set time

Use this option to set the system time. Note that the same facility is provided by the MS-DOS TIME command.

The screen will look like this:

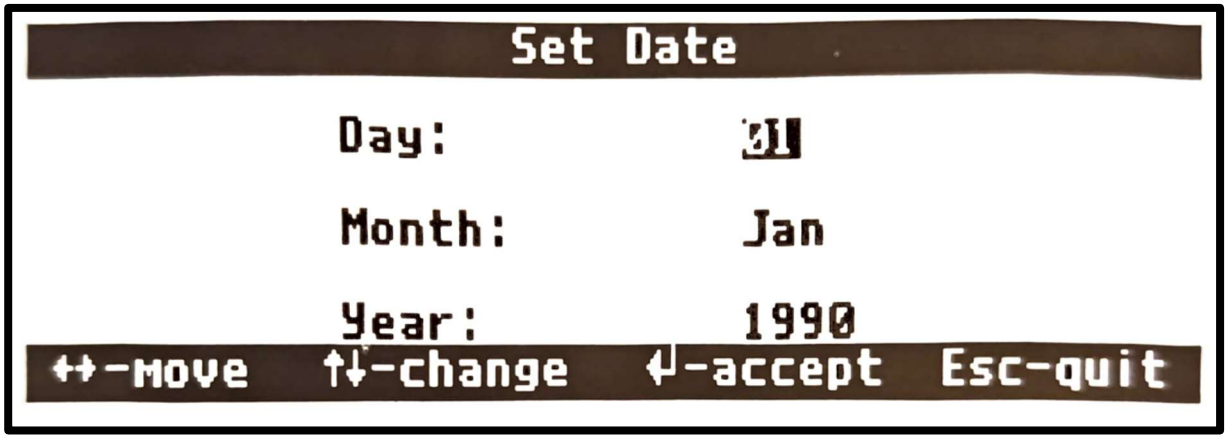



Move the highlight to the time field that you want to change, by using the [Up] or [Down] key, then adjust the value by using the or key. Press [RETURN] to accept the new time and return to the main UTIL menu, or press [ESC] to cancel the changes.

## 8.4 Set date

Use this option to set the system date. Note that the same facility is provided by the MS-DOS DATE command.

The screen will look like this:




Move the highlight to the date field that you want to change, by using the [Left] or [Right] key, then adjust the value by using the [Up] or [Down] key. Press [RETURN] to accept the new date and return to the main UTIL menu, or press [Esc] to cancel the changes.

Note that **Hunter 16** adjusts month length for leap years, but does not adjust for British Summer Time or other local time changes.

## 8.5 Format diskette

Use this option to format 3.5" diskettes in the **Oracle GT** drive. You must format new diskettes before you can use them, either by using this option or by formatting them on a suitable desktop computer, using its standard FORMAT command.

The screen will look like this:

Check that the format is as you want it ie the diskette is suitable for the density and whether you want to make the diskette bootable. When you are ready to format the diskette, press [Return] and the following screen will be displayed:

Press any key to begin formatting, or [Esc] to return to the main menu,

WARNING: Formatting destroys any information already on the specified disk.

When the disk has been formatted, you are returned to the same screen. To format another diskette, simply press [RETURN] again.

WARNING: Do not use any other commands (such as the MS-DOS FORMAT or FXPREP commands) on **Hunter 16** to format the RAM disk. You may however format normal diskettes in or for the Oracle GT disk drive (but not system diskettes) by using the standard FORMAT command.

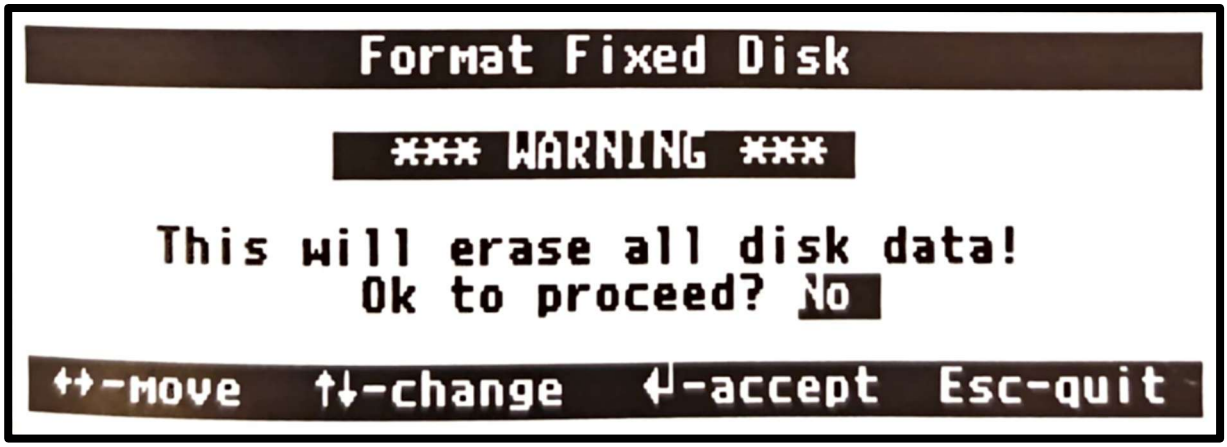
## 8.6 Format fixed disk

Use this option to format the RAM disk or change the way that the **Hunter 16** RAM is used. You should not need to do this in normal usage, but might for the following reasons:

- The disk has been corrupted by running a program which crashed.
- The disk has been corrupted by depriving Hunter 16 of power (main batteries or AC adaptor) for more than a month.
- The disk contains data of a sensitive nature that you wish to destroy.
- The memory size has been corrupted.
- You have fitted more memory (see section 13.4).

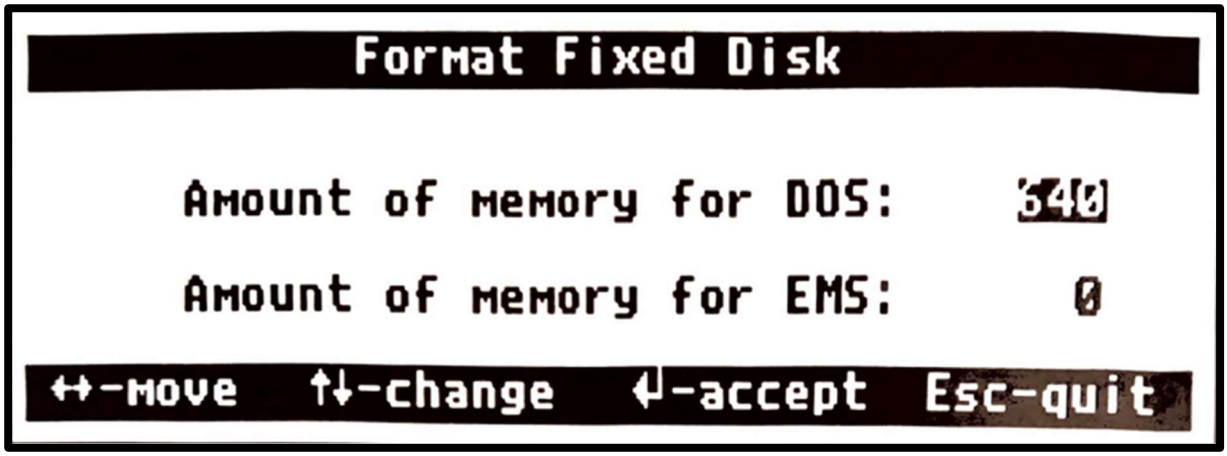
You might also need to use this option to change the partitioning of **Hunter 16's** memory between DOS memory, RAM disk and EMS memory. For example, if you need to increase the DOS memory size to run a large application.

The screen will look like this:




To format the disk, press [Up] or [Down] to select **`Yes`**, then press . To return to the main menu without formatting the disk, press [Esc].

You will next be asked to select the memory configuration required:




The first option allows you to specify how much of the first 1MByte of memory will be allocated to DOS, up to 640KByte. Any unallocated memory will be allocated to the fixed disk. (The more memory you allocate to DOS, the larger the programs you can run.)

The second option allows you to specify how much of the memory fitted above 1MByte will be allocated to use for EMS. Any unallocated memory will be allocated to the fixed disk. (To use this EMS memory you must install an EMS driver and use applications or utilities that can use EMS memory. For more details, see Part 3.)

Press [RETURN] and formatting will begin. When it has finished, a screen like the following will be displayed:

Press any key and Hunter 16 will reboot.

**WARNING:** Formatting destroys all user information on the RAM disk. It does not however remove any of the system files, such as the operating system, standard utilities, EDIT and UTIL.

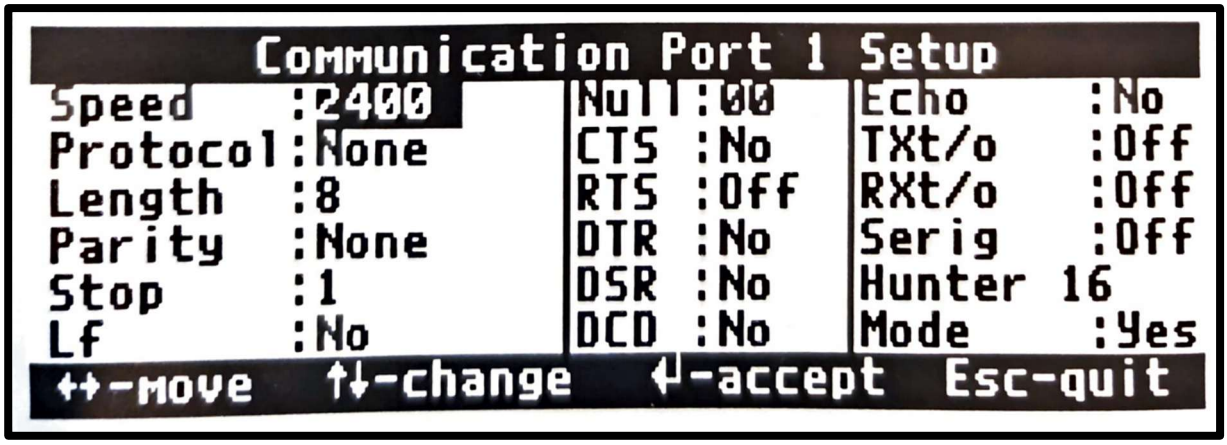
**WARNING**: Do not use any other commands (such as the MS-DOS FORMAT or FXPREP commands) on **Hunter 16** to format the RAM disk. You may however format normal diskettes in or for the **Oracle GT** disk drive (but not system diskettes) by using the standard FORMAT command.

## 8.7 Communication Port 1 Setup

Use this option to select and configure Husky-style communications for COM1 (the main serial port), or to restore IBM communications.

- Husky communications has the following advantages:
- support for protocols (XON/XOFF and any optional protocols installed), providing more secure data transfer
- configurable handshaking, to suit a wide variety of devices and
- connection methods
- faster data transfer (up to 38,400 Baud) for efficient
- communications
- data buffering for reliable fast transfer
- compatibility with other Husky handheld computers (such as **Husky Hunter** and **Husky Hawk**)

This screen will look like this:




This shows the current configuration of COM1, and allows you to alter it by using the cursor keys.

To restore IBM communications, simply set **`Hunter 16 Mode`** to No and press [RETURN].

To select Husky communications, simply set **`Hunter 16 Mode`** to **`Yes`**, set the other parameters as required, and then press [RETURN].

To cancel any changes you have made, press [Esc].

You will normally simply select a configuration to suit the device that is connected to the port. For more details of the significance of the various options, see Chapter 11. Note that if you are going to use the **Hunter 16 Printer Sidebox**, you should set DTR to **`On`**.

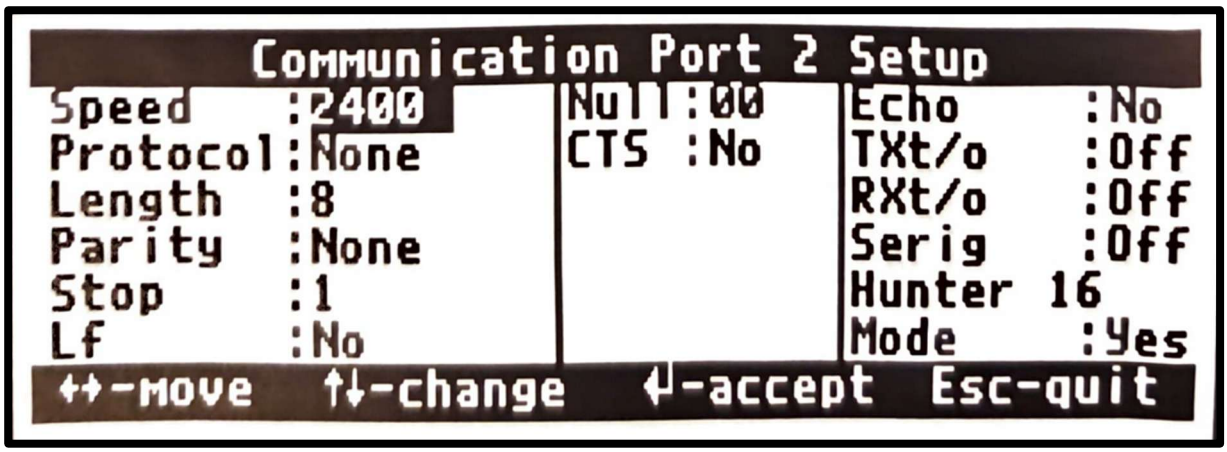
The configurations that you select will normally remain in force until you use this option again. However, IBM-style communications will be resumed if you use an application or command (such as MODE COM1) which re-initialises communications; to re-select Husky communications, simply select this option again.

Standard (MS-DOS) applications which control the port hardware directly (such as certain communications packages) will also ignore the configuration set using this option.

## 8.8 Communication Port 2 Setup

Use this option to select and configure Husky communications for COM2 (the secondary RS232 port), or to restore IBM communications.

The screen will look like this:




You can use this much like the Communication Port 1 Setup option, to configure COM2. Note that the COM2 interface is some what simpler, so the only handshaking option available is CTS. When you are happy with the configuration of COM2, press [RETURN] to return to the main menu.